

@bitcoin.daily

THE 5-PHASE BITCOIN HALVING CYCLE GUIDE

The framework that called 3 cycles in a row.

2016 · 2020 · 2024

Not vibes. Not narratives. History.

WHY THIS GUIDE EXISTS

THE TRACK RECORD

In March 2024, I publicly mapped Bitcoin's 5-phase halving cycle using data from 2016 and 2020. Every single phase played out again — for the 3rd consecutive cycle. This isn't hindsight. The original post is timestamped.

What this guide gives you:

- A framework to know exactly WHERE you are in Bitcoin's cycle at any point
- Historical data from all 3 halving cycles (2016, 2020, 2024) with specific numbers
- What to do — and what NOT to do — during each phase
- How to recognize each phase in real time so you stop making emotional decisions
- The bear market roadmap: where the data says we're headed next

WHO THIS IS FOR

Traders and investors who understand Bitcoin but keep getting caught on the wrong side of the cycle. You've held through a bear market. You've panic-sold a dip that turned into a rally. You've watched a peak happen and wished you'd taken profits.

This guide is the framework so that doesn't happen again.

WHY CYCLES EXIST

It's not magic. It's code.

Every 210,000 blocks (roughly every 4 years), Bitcoin's protocol automatically cuts the number of new coins created per block in half. This is called the halving. It's not a theory, a prediction, or an opinion. It's written into Bitcoin's source code and will continue until the last Bitcoin is mined around the year 2140.

The Supply Schedule

HALVING	DATE	BLOCK REWARD	NEW BTC/DAY
Genesis	Jan 2009	50 BTC	~7,200
Halving 1	Nov 2012	25 BTC	~3,600
Halving 2	Jul 2016	12.5 BTC	~1,800
Halving 3	May 2020	6.25 BTC	~900
Halving 4	Apr 2024	3.125 BTC	~450
Halving 5	~2028	1.5625 BTC	~225

The Logic

Every halving creates a supply shock. The number of new Bitcoin entering circulation gets cut in half overnight, but demand doesn't drop with it. The result is a predictable market cycle:

Supply drops → Scarcity increases → Price adjusts upward → Euphoria builds → Market overextends → Crash → Reset.

This cycle has repeated with remarkable consistency across all three post-halving periods. The narratives change every time. The structure doesn't.

As long as halvings are in the code, cycles will exist. That's not a belief. That's a protocol.

THE 5 PHASES — OVERVIEW

Every Bitcoin halving cycle moves through the same 5 phases. The timing varies. The catalysts change. The structure stays identical.

1

Pre-Halving Accumulation

The quiet period after a bear market bottom. Survivors accumulate while the crowd declares Bitcoin dead.

2

Pre-Halving Rally

As the halving approaches, hype builds and price runs. This is the "buy the news" phase.

3

Pre-Halving Pullback

A correction in the weeks around the halving. "Sell the news." Shakes out the tourists.

4

Post-Halving Accumulation

The boring sideways period after the halving. Everyone asks "is the bull market over?" It hasn't started.

5

Post-Halving Rally

The parabolic run Bitcoin is famous for. Life-changing returns over roughly a year.

CONFIRMED ACROSS 3 CONSECUTIVE CYCLES

2016 Halving ✓ 2020 Halving ✓ 2024 Halving ✓

PRE-HALVING

ACCUMULATION

After every bear market bottom, Bitcoin enters a long, quiet accumulation phase. Retail has given up. Media coverage disappears. "Bitcoin is dead" headlines peak. Meanwhile, the survivors — the ones who've seen this before — are loading up.

Across 3 Cycles:

2016 CYCLE

Bottom: ~\$200 (Jan 2015) • Accumulation range: \$200–\$450 • Duration: ~518 days

2020 CYCLE

Bottom: ~\$3,200 (Dec 2018) • Accumulation range: \$3,200–\$10,000 • Duration: ~518 days

2024 CYCLE

Bottom: \$15,500 (Nov 2022) • Accumulation range: \$16,000–\$30,000 • Duration: ~511 days

WHAT TO DO

Accumulate. Be patient. Ignore the noise. This is where generational wealth positions are built — when nobody's watching and nothing's happening. Dollar-cost average. Don't try to time the exact bottom.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE IT

Maximum pessimism. Low volume. "Bitcoin is dead" articles everywhere. Your friends stopped asking about crypto. Social media engagement at lows. The market feels boring. That's the signal.

PRE-HALVING RALLY

As the halving event approaches (typically 60–90 days out), the narrative shifts. Media starts covering the halving countdown. Retail interest picks up. A "buy the news" rally kicks in. The catalyst is different every cycle. The phase isn't.

Across 3 Cycles:

2016 CYCLE

Rally: ~\$200 → ~\$780 • Gain: +290% • Duration: ~182 days

2020 CYCLE

Rally: ~\$5,000 → ~\$10,000 • Gain: +100% (then Covid hit) • Duration: ~35 days

2024 CYCLE

Rally: ~\$25,000 → \$73,000 • Gain: +192% (ETF-fueled) • Duration: ~175 days

WHAT TO DO

Ride it — but don't get greedy. The pullback is coming. This is where early accumulators start taking partial profits. Have a plan BEFORE the rally starts. If you're chasing entries here, you're late.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE IT

Halving countdown dominates the narrative. FOMO kicks in. Retail enters. "This time the halving is going to send Bitcoin to \$X" everywhere. Price accelerates on increasing volume.

PRE-HALVING

PULLBACK

A few weeks before (or right around) the halving, a correction hits. "Sell the news." The hype fades, reality sets in, and the market shakes out everyone who bought the top of the pre-halving rally. This has happened every single time.

Across 3 Cycles:

2016 CYCLE

Pullback: -38% • Duration: ~42 days

2020 CYCLE

Pullback: -20% (Covid amplified to -63%) • Duration: ~14 days

2024 CYCLE

Pullback: -23% (\$73K → \$56K) • Duration: ~35 days

WHAT TO DO

Don't panic sell. This is the shakeout — it's happened every cycle. If you accumulated in Phase 1, hold your position. If you're looking to add, this pullback can be an opportunity. The parabolic move hasn't started yet.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE IT

"The halving was priced in" narrative everywhere. Media turns bearish. Fear index spikes. People who bought the rally top start selling at a loss. Social media sentiment flips negative. The tourists leave.

POST-HALVING

ACCUMULATION

Right after the halving, Bitcoin goes quiet. Again. The supply shock has happened but the market hasn't reacted yet. Price ranges sideways for weeks or months. This is the phase where most people give up and sell too early — right before the biggest move of the entire cycle.

Across 3 Cycles:

2016 CYCLE

Sideways: ~147 days • Range: \$500–\$780 • "Is Bitcoin dead?" sentiment

2020 CYCLE

Sideways: ~147 days • Range: \$8,500–\$10,000 • Boring. Quiet. Perfect.

2024 CYCLE

Sideways: ~170 days • Range: \$56,000–\$72,000 • "Bull market over" everywhere

WHAT TO DO

Hold. Accumulate on dips. Wait. This is the calm before the storm. The parabolic rally hasn't started yet — it just feels like nothing is happening. Patience here is what separates the people who catch the rally from the ones who sold too early.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE IT

Boredom. Low engagement. People asking "is the bull market over?" Price goes sideways for months. Volume dries up. Nobody's excited. This is the signal that the big move is loading.

POST-HALVING RALLY

This is what Bitcoin is famous for. The parabolic run. The phase that creates millionaires and dominates headlines. After months of accumulation, the supply shock finally manifests in price. The rally typically lasts about a year and produces life-changing returns — though they diminish each cycle.

Across 3 Cycles:

2016 CYCLE

Rally: +3,000% • \$530 → \$19,700 • Duration: 525 days • Peaked Dec 2017

2020 CYCLE

Rally: +700% • \$8,800 → \$69,000 • Duration: 539 days • Peaked Nov 2021

2024 CYCLE

Rally: +125% • \$56,000 → \$126,000 • Duration: ~364 days • Peaked Oct 2025

DIMINISHING RETURNS PATTERN

+3,000% → +700% → +125% — Each cycle's rally is smaller. Still life-changing. Plan accordingly.

WHAT TO DO

Ride it WITH A PLAN. Take profits in stages. Set exit targets BEFORE euphoria hits. Don't wait for the top — nobody calls the exact top. Sell in tranches on the way up. The people who lose in this phase are the ones who never take profits.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE IT

Euphoria. Mainstream media coverage. Your Uber driver asks about Bitcoin. "This time is different" and "we're going higher" everywhere. When it feels like it'll never stop going up — that's when it's almost over.

THE PROOF — 3 CYCLES

Cycle 1: 2016 Halving (2015–2018)

The 2016 halving reduced the block reward from 25 BTC to 12.5 BTC. All 5 phases played out. Bitcoin went from a bear market bottom around \$200 to a peak of \$19,700 in December 2017 — then crashed 84%.



All 5 phases confirmed ✓ Peak: \$19,700 (Dec 2017) Post-peak drawdown: -84%

Cycle 2: 2020 Halving (2019–2022)

The 2020 halving reduced the block reward from 12.5 BTC to 6.25 BTC. Covid made the pre-halving pullback more severe (-63%), but the structure held. Bitcoin rallied from ~\$8,800 to \$69,000 over 539 days — then crashed 77%.



All 5 phases confirmed ✓ Peak: \$69,000 (Nov 2021) Post-peak drawdown: -77%

Cycle 3: 2024 Halving (2023–2026)

The 2024 halving reduced the block reward from 6.25 BTC to 3.125 BTC. The ETF approval pulled the pre-halving rally forward, but the structure held. Again. Bitcoin rallied from \$56,000 to \$126,000 — and is now in the post-peak correction. The cycle continues.



All 5 phases confirmed ✓ Peak: \$126,000 (Oct 2025) Current drawdown: -47%

THE BEAR MARKET

Every post-halving rally ends with a peak, followed by a bear market that resets the cycle. This is the phase nobody talks about during the euphoria. It's also the phase that creates the next generation of buyers — at lower prices.

Every Post-Peak Bear Market:

2013 → 2015

Peak: \$1,150 • Bottom: \$200 • Drawdown: -83% • Duration: ~14 months

2017 → 2018

Peak: \$19,700 • Bottom: \$3,200 • Drawdown: -84% • Duration: ~12 months

2021 → 2022

Peak: \$69,000 • Bottom: \$15,500 • Drawdown: -77% • Duration: ~12 months

2025 → ?

Peak: \$126,000 • Current: ~\$67,000 • Drawdown: -47% (so far)

WHAT THE DATA SUGGESTS

Historical bottom window: Q3–Q4 2026 (based on ~12 month average drawdown duration)

Historical drawdown range: -77% to -84% from peak

Implied target range: \$40,000–\$55,000

WHAT TO DO

Protect capital. Reduce exposure. Build your watchlist. Prepare your accumulation plan for the next cycle's Phase 1. The bear market is where the next bull run's winners position themselves.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE THE BOTTOM

Extreme fear. Capitulation events. "Bitcoin is dead" headlines return. Exchanges see mass withdrawals. Social engagement at cycle lows. It will feel like the worst time to buy. Historically, that's the signal.

COMMON MISTAKES BY PHASE

The cycle is predictable. Human behavior during it is also predictable — predictably wrong. Here's what most people do at each phase and why it costs them.

Phase 1: Accumulation

THE MISTAKE: Not buying because "it could go lower."

THE REALITY: You don't need to catch the exact bottom. You need to be in before Phase 5.

Phase 2: Pre-Halving Rally

THE MISTAKE: Going all-in at the top of the rally.

THE REALITY: The pullback is coming. Every single time. Scale in, don't lump sum at highs.

Phase 3: Pullback

THE MISTAKE: Panic selling the dip.

THE REALITY: This shakeout has happened every cycle. The people who sold here missed everything after.

Phase 4: Post-Halving Accumulation

THE MISTAKE: Getting bored and selling too early.

THE REALITY: The biggest move of the cycle hasn't started yet. Patience is the edge.

Phase 5: Rally

THE MISTAKE: Never taking profits because "it's going higher."

THE REALITY: Every rally ends. Set exit targets before euphoria makes the decision for you.

Phase 0: Bear Market

THE MISTAKE: Holding 100% through the entire crash without a plan.

THE REALITY: Risk management isn't about being bearish. It's about surviving to play the next cycle.

THE FULL CYCLE MAP

The complete cycle — from bear market bottom to bear market bottom — takes approximately 4 years. It resets with every halving. The next halving is projected for 2028, and the cycle will begin again.

PHASE 1

Pre-Halving Accumulation

~1-2 years
before halving

Bear market bottom.
Survivors accumulate.

PHASE 2

Pre-Halving Rally

~2-6 months
before halving

Hype builds.
Price runs.

PHASE 3

Pre-Halving Pullback

Weeks around
the halving

Sell the news.
Shakeout.

PHASE 4

Post-Halving Accumulation

~3-6 months
after halving

Sideways. Boring.
The calm before the storm.

PHASE 5

Post-Halving Rally

~6-18 months
after halving

Parabolic run.
Life-changing returns.

PHASE 0

Bear Market

~12 months
after peak

The reset.
Cycle repeats.

THE REPEATING TIMELINE

2012 → 2016 → 2020 → 2024 → 2028

Each halving resets the cycle. The narratives change. The structure doesn't.

NOW YOU KNOW WHERE WE ARE IN THE CYCLE.

The question is what you do with it.

JOIN THE TRADING COMMUNITY

I call every trade live in my Discord — with entries, stops, and targets — before I take them. Through every phase of the cycle. See it for yourself.

7-day free trial → [Link in bio](#)

1-ON-1 MENTORSHIP

Want personalized help building your cycle strategy and trading system? Limited spots available each month.

DM me "Mentorship" on Instagram

FOLLOW @bitcoin.daily

Daily cycle updates. Market analysis. Trade breakdowns.

Not vibes. Not narratives. History.